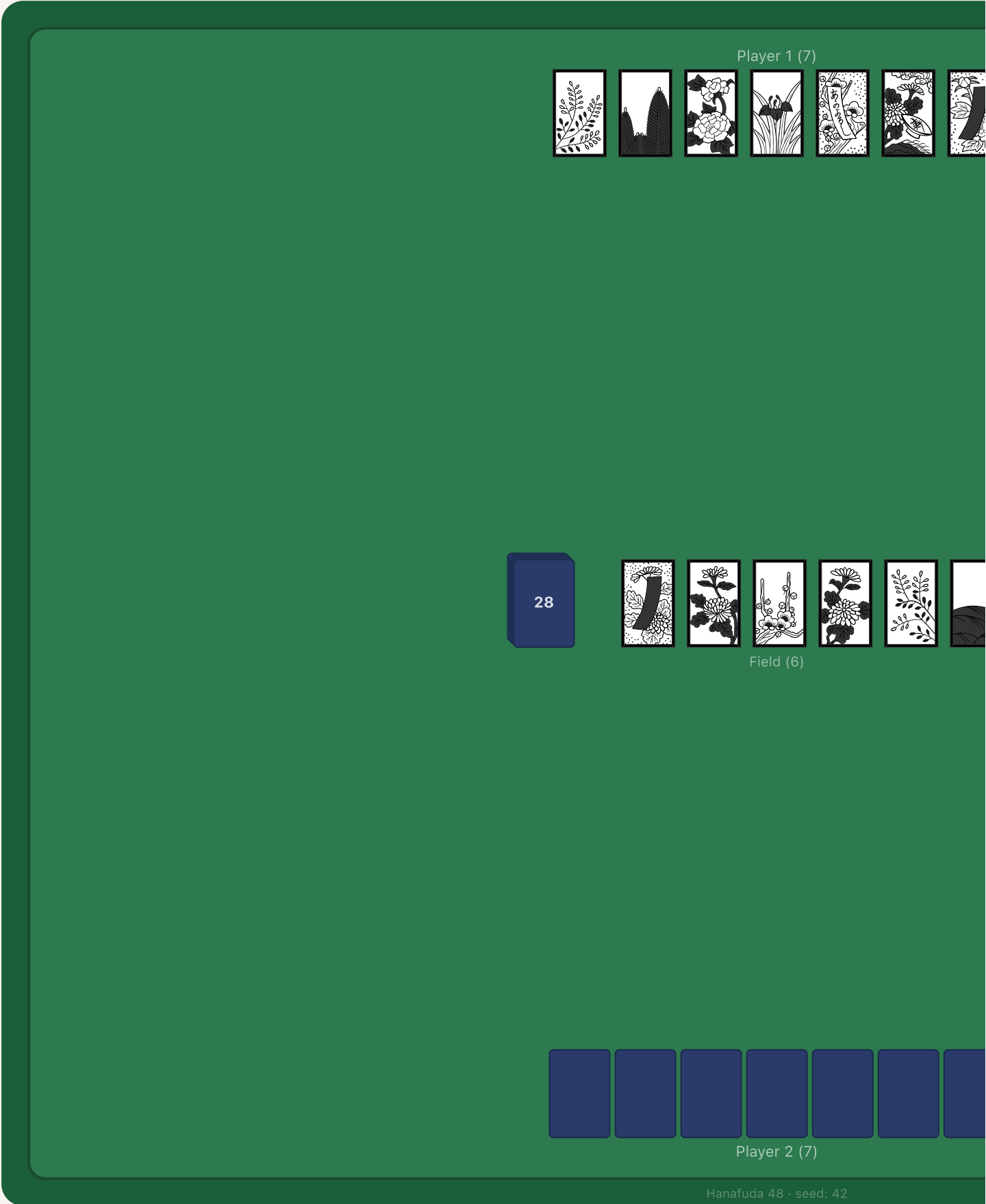


GO-STOP

Go-Stop (고스톱, also called Godori or Hwatu) is the most popular card game in South Korea, played with a Hwatu deck – the Korean version of the Japanese hanafuda deck. Like Koi-Koi, it uses matching by month and collection of scoring combinations. Its defining mechanic is the **Go/Stop decision**: after reaching a scoring threshold, the current player must choose whether to declare “Stop” (take winnings) or “Go” (continue for bigger rewards at increasing risk).



Go-Stop – table layout

THE DECK

48 Hwatu cards in 12 suits (months), 4 cards per month. Card types by value:

- ♦ **Bright (광, Gwang):** 5 cards, one each in January (Pine), March (Cherry Blossom), August (Full Moon), November (Rain), and December (Phoenix)
- ♦ **Animal (열꿩, Yeolggeut):** 9 cards
- ♦ **Ribbon (때, Ddi):** 10 cards, in three types: Red Poetry (Jan, Feb, Mar), Blue (Jun, Sep, Oct), and Plain
- ♦ **Junk (피, Pi):** 24 cards; some months have a bonus double-junk card worth 2 junk

THE DEAL (3-PLAYER)

Each player is dealt **7 cards**. **6 cards** are placed face-up on the field. Remaining cards form the draw pile.

THE TURN

- 1 Play a card from hand:** if it matches a field card's month, capture both; if no match, place it on the field
- 2 Draw from the pile:** if the drawn card matches a field card's month, capture both; if no match, place it on the field
- 3 Check for Go/Stop:** if the player now meets the scoring threshold, they must declare Go or Stop

SPECIAL CAPTURES

Ttadak (따닥): if the card played from hand AND the drawn card both match field cards of the **same month** (capturing two separate pairs in one turn), the player earns a bonus and each opponent pays 1 chip penalty.

Triple field capture: if three cards of the same month are already on the field when you play the fourth, you capture all four.

SCORING COMBINATIONS

Brights:

- ♦ 3 non-Rain Brights = 3 pts
- ♦ 3 Brights including Rain (November) = 2 pts
- ♦ 4 Brights = 4 pts
- ♦ 5 Brights = 15 pts

Animals:

- ♦ 5 animals = 1 pt; +1 pt per additional animal
- ♦ Godori (고도리): Cuckoo (February) + Bush Warbler (April) + Geese (August) = 5 pts

Ribbons:

- ♦ 5 ribbons = 1 pt; +1 pt per additional ribbon
- ♦ Red Poetry ribbons (Jan + Feb + Mar) = 3 pts
- ♦ Blue ribbons (Jun + Sep + Oct) = 3 pts

Junk:

- ♦ 10 junk cards = 1 pt; +1 pt per additional junk
- ♦ Double-junk cards count as 2

THE GO/STOP DECISION

When a player reaches **3 points** (or the agreed threshold), they must announce:

- ♦ **“Stop” (스톱):** collect winnings. Other players pay the stopping player. Round ends.
- ♦ **“Go” (고):** continue. Scoring accumulates. A player who has said “Go” cannot later collect fewer points than accrued.

Risk of “Go”: If another player stops first, or the draw pile is exhausted before the Go-player stops, the player who said “Go” pays **double penalties** to the winner. Each additional “Go” declaration multiplies the payout by 2.

If the “Go” player successfully stops later without another player stopping first, they collect at a multiplied rate.

PENALTIES

Other players pay the winner chips based on the winner’s total points. Bonus payments apply for winning with 7+ points, for opponents holding only junk, and for multiple “Go” declarations.

2-PLAYER GO-STOP

Each player receives **10 cards**; 8 cards are placed on the field. Otherwise identical to 3-player.